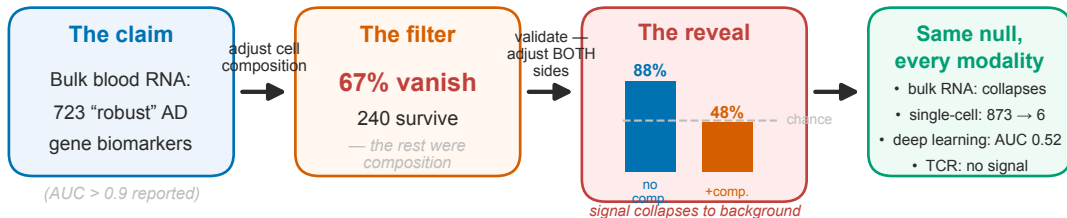


Blood-RNA “biomarkers” of Alzheimer’s disease are myeloid cell counts in disguise



The AD blood gene signal is predominantly explained by myeloid leukocyte composition.

Limited evidence for a composition-independent signature — and APOE genotype alone (AUC 0.71) beats the whole transcriptomic panel.

Lesson: adjust composition on discovery AND validation, and use donor-level statistics, or you will rediscover cell counts.